Revealing the Growth Curve

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How To Prepare For Growth Curve Facilitation

Steps required…

1. **Global Positioning of the Growth Curve**
2. **Reveal the Growth Curve via a Persona (in order to ensure talking in 3rd person/ create dissociation)**
3. **Create (Client) Relevance to the Curve**

Step 1: Global Positioning of the Curve (script example)

"This is the Growth Curve. (What it is) is a framework that explains the 9 stages of business growth; from the time a business owner first develops their idea - right up until the day they sell it and walk off with a bag of money.

We use it with our clients because it highlights the types of issues that business owners can expect to encounter BEFORE they have to cope; so they're better prepared and therefore, more successful."

"Let's take a look at it through the eyes of (Bob the Chocolate maker)…"

Why 3rd Person / Persona?

We need to create dissociation in order to avoid judgement/assessment of the concept before the entire concept has been understood. Using a Persona ensures the facilitator starts in 3rd person and **(by staying in character)** remains in 3rd person throughout the concept delivery. Persona's also create 'permission' for humour and 'exaggerated elements' to be introduced; thus reducing jargon and complexity whilst increasing memory/ concept retention.

Additionally, we need to overcome the stigma/stereotype of accountant's being logical, analytical and (boring). Storytelling allows you to create a different 'feel' in your meetings *(making clients WANT to spend more time with you.)*

Step 2: Develop your persona…

- Name of your Business Owner
- Name of the Business
- Age of Owner
- Why did they start the business?
- What is their 'quirky' / 'sticky' (point of difference) product feature? {Chocolate with rust in it from washing machine mixer or Steak and Rhubarb flavoured pies as example)

Step 3: Create Client Relevance…

"So where do you think you sit on the curve?"
"What makes you say that?"
"Where do you want to be on the curve, and by when?"

Reveal 'The Story' *(To Make Your Point)* In The Third Person Style

1	2	3
Explain The Concept & Establish Client Understanding	Gain Agreement Of The Concept (as being valid) In Principle.	Create Client Relevance
Delivered in 3rd person (style) to allow clear distinction between concept & client application.	(You only need to verbalise this if the client's are skeptical or overly resistant.)	(You may only need to 'amplify' this - your client may have shown this by virtue of questions or agreement statements.)
"Let's look at this through the eyes of Bill & Mary and their chocolate shop..."	"So if we use Bill and Mary's case as a reference, would the concept be valid - in THEIR case?"	"So in YOUR case, how do you think this concept could apply?"

How Does The Session End?

Remember: The purpose (objective) of using the Growth Curve in your EOY meeting is to improve (advisor/client) alignment and to (re) position you as a Strategic Advisor in the mind of your client.

DON'T BLOW IT by selling too fast.

Instead of talking about all the strategic services you could offer (based on the Growth Curve conversation) simply ask the following… "So now that we're both clear on where you're trying to get to on the curve, would you be open to me offering you ideas or highlighting problem areas - as and when I think they could help you?"

Yes - "Great, I'll put my thinking cap on and be in touch going forward…"

Remember also, you'll be discussing 4 possible service solutions to their cash Volatility later in the EOY meeting so dropping a load of 'strategic observations' at this point is only going to confuse your client.

You'll also recall that the 4 processing styles (Activist, Pragmatist, Reflector, Theorist) means that you need to allow a (small) bit of time to pass for your client to 'absorb/process' the Growth Curve concept AND YOU as a 'Strategic Advisor'.

Make a note in your diary to touch base with them (regarding Growth Curve observations) within 14 days of your EOY meeting.

Common Q&A

Q: How should I manage space on the page when drawing the framework? A: It is important to give yourself plenty of room so that elements, such as the curve, don't end up drawn too close to the bottom of the page. You also need to plan ahead to leave gaps for specific milestones along the curve, such as "break even" and "lifestyle".

Q: Why is it necessary to write out the title and framework live, even if I have bad handwriting? A: Although your brain might scream at you because people are watching, writing it out live is a crucial part of the "reveal". It slows the audience's brain down, draws them into your delivery, and creates focused attention and curiosity so they are ready to absorb the information.

Q: What is the "chunking" technique and how should it be executed? A: "Chunking" involves presenting the phases of the framework (like design, launch, and break even) in blocks of three. You must write all three steps down first, and only speak about them after they are written. If you try to write one step, explain it, and then write the next, you are much more likely to get confused or lose your place.

Q: Does it matter if I mess up the order of the drawings? A: No, you don't need to get too carried away with the exact order when drawing secondary elements like the "devil's toilet" or the split point. If you get them in the wrong order, it doesn't matter.

Q: Why does the presentation use rhyming words like "artisan" and "businessman"? A: The rhyming is designed intentionally so the concept sticks in the prospect's head. It introduces the idea that while someone might be a highly skilled craftsperson or technician, that doesn't necessarily prepare them for the business side of things—which perfectly illustrates why they are going to need your help.

Q: How should I practice this presentation to build confidence? A: You should practice delivering it at least 10 times before showing your first customer. You can practice with your wife, children, next-door neighbor, or even your dog to build up your confidence.